

10-Point Direct Booking Checklist

How European B&Bs are pulling 20% more direct bookings from their existing social media links

Most independent property owners already have everything they need to take more direct bookings — they just haven't connected the dots yet. Work through this checklist and tick off each point. The owners consistently taking 20% more direct bookings tick 8 or more.

1 Your Facebook page has a Book Now button

Add your NestBook booking page as a direct Book Now button on your Facebook business page. Guests who find you on Facebook book directly — no Booking.com, no commission.

2 Your booking page URL is in your Instagram bio

Instagram only allows one link in bio — make it your direct booking page. Every follower who visits your profile can book straight with you.

3 You respond to Booking.com reviews with your direct link

When guests leave a review, your reply is public. End every reply with: 'We hope to welcome you back — book direct next time at nestbook.io/book/your-property for our best rates.'

4 Your email signature has a direct booking link

Every email you send is a marketing opportunity. Add 'Book direct for best rates: nestbook.io/book/your-property' to your email signature. It costs nothing and works 24/7.

5 You have a Google Business Profile with your booking link

A verified Google Business Profile shows your property in local search results. Add your NestBook booking page as your website link — guests searching locally can book directly.

6 Your repeat guests know they can book direct next time

At checkout, tell your guests: 'Next time, book directly with us at nestbook.io/book/your-property — you'll always get our best rate and we save the commission.' Simple and honest.

7 You have a shareable booking page guests can recommend

Word of mouth is your most powerful marketing tool. A clean, professional booking page at nestbook.io/book/your-property is easy to share, looks great on any device, and works in 5 languages.

8 Your iCal is synced to prevent double bookings

Direct bookings only work if your calendar is accurate. Sync your NestBook calendar with Booking.com and Airbnb via iCal — any direct booking instantly blocks those dates on all platforms.

9 You have at least one photo per room on your booking page

Properties with photos convert at dramatically higher rates than those without. Even one good photo per room makes a real difference. Guests book what they can see.

10 You follow up with guests after their stay

A short thank-you email after checkout with a direct booking link for next time costs nothing and converts well. Guests who loved their stay are your most likely repeat bookings.